

The software to use for post processing

Now that you are fairly familiar with “what” should be done, let us see the “how” part too. Depending on what area of photography you are pursuing, there are several mainstream programs you can use to edit your images. The volume of images and the extent of editing desired will guide your choice of software. The most popular options within the community remain Lightroom and Photoshop, and Aperture for Mac users

Targeted at the professional photographer, Lightroom and Aperture provide a complete workflow solution for managing, editing and outputting digital images. While Lightroom and Aperture are perfect for the casual editor and have been made keeping the photographer in mind, Photoshop is still where the advanced post processing takes place, like exposure blending, panoramic stitching, cloning and other intricately detailed works that most other programs are still not equipped to handle. Essentially, Lightroom provides you with many tools and processes that streamline your editing, like modules or filmstrip, which is fantastic for photographers who have large volumes of work and are going to apply relatively simple edits to batches of photos at once, in a more simple, straightforward and reversible way than in Photoshop. Aperture, like Lightroom, has many great organizational features with a bit different interface, like the “Develop Module” feature in Lightroom is similar to the “Adjustments” in Aperture. Both have there much debated and compared lists of pros and cons, but in general it is widely agreed that Lightroom is better for printing and Aperture is more streamlined in organizing your images (mainly due to the Books feature). Then of course there is the ever favorite Photoshop, which is still somewhat of an industry standard. The software became so popular that the word is now commonly used as a verb referring to editing and post processing of images in general. A more sophisticated software in all respects, its biggest benefit is layers – more precisely the ability to mask or blend layers to create a mosaic of edits in the right combinations. The learning curve is rather steep for this one, but the reward is certainly worth it.



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